

IN 1900, EUROPEANS CONTROLLED 90 PERCENT OF AFRICA



Ethiopia

The only African nation never to have been colonized.

Boer Republics

Formed by descendants of 17th-century Dutch settlers on land already inhabited by native peoples, these were annexed by Britain in 1902.

Scramble for Africa

The Atlantic slave trade, in which Africans were forcibly sold to people in the Americas, ended in the mid-19th century. European powers colonized Africa for economic, political, and religious reasons, scrambling to claim territory before their rivals.

- **1871:** Germany and Italy are both unified. No more territory available for expansion of empires in Europe.

- **1884–85:** Berlin Conference, where European powers decide rules on carving up Africa.

- **1900:** Only a handful of regions are still independent states. Britain rules 30 percent of Africa's population.

The Great Game

In the 1830s, Britain feared Russia was planning on invading British-ruled India through controlling India's neighbor, Afghanistan. The "Great Game" was the rivalry for power in Asia between the British and Russian empires.

- **1839–42:** First Anglo-Afghan War. Terrible defeat at Kabul for the British.

- **1878–80:** Second Anglo-Afghan War. Russia is defeated and Britain withdraws but takes control of Afghanistan's foreign affairs.

- **1907:** Russia and Britain sign a peace treaty in the face of the German threat of expansion in the Middle East.